

Paper 3: Reading and understanding in French

Content

Students are assessed on their understanding of written French across a range of genres and in both formal and informal contexts.

Students need to:

- identify and respond to key points, details and opinions
- recognise the relationship between past, present and future events
- infer meanings of two single words per tier (1 mark per word) that are not listed in *Appendix 1: Vocabulary*
- demonstrate an ability to transfer meaning accurately into English by translating from written French into English.

This paper draws on the specified vocabulary (*Appendix 1*) and grammar (*Appendix 2*) and the focus of the passages will be taken from the thematic contexts listed in the specification (see [Thematic Contexts](#)).

Texts have been created to reflect the following authentic reading scenarios:

- blogs, internet forums, advertisements, tourist brochures, newspaper or magazine articles, emails, extracts from a diary or school project.

Texts for individual questions within the assessment vary in length, including both short and longer written passages.

Scenarios in the texts are set either at home or, more frequently, in a French-speaking country, allowing students to develop appropriate cultural awareness and understanding. When specific cultural features are mentioned, we will include an image to ensure all students can have equal understanding of the cultural feature.

To avoid students confusing unfamiliar names of people with necessary vocabulary, we will only use names from the prescribed list in *Appendix 3*.

Assessment information

First assessment: May/June 2026.

The assessment is out of 50 marks.

Section A: Reading comprehension (40 marks)

All questions in this section are set in English, using the following question types: multiple choice, multiple response and short open response questions.

Students write their responses in English for any open response questions.